

Android Auto User Guide

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A SAMPLE USER MANUAL
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Abstract

A brief summary of the application "Android Auto"

Android Auto is a mobile app that allows you to access features of your smartphone, such as navigation, music, and messaging, while driving. It integrates with your car's display and uses voice commands and touch screen controls for a safer driving experience. It works with compatible Android phones and vehicles, and requires a USB connection or wireless projection.

Notice

This information was developed for the product Android Auto™ and the product related services offered by Google.

The information contained in this user guide is intended to provide users with a comprehensive understanding of the Android Auto™ product and its related services offered by Google. It may be updated from time to time and the latest version can be found on the official Android Auto™ website. Users are advised to regularly check for updates to ensure that they have the most accurate and up-to-date information. Please note that this information is provided as is and may not reflect the current state of the product or its services. Google and its affiliates assume no responsibility for any errors or omissions in the information contained in this user guide.

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Preface

Welcome to the world of Android Auto™, where technology and convenience meet on the road. With the Android Auto™ platform, you can safely and easily access your favorite apps and services while driving, using only your voice or a touch on the in-dash display. Whether you're looking for directions, music, or just want to stay connected, Android Auto™ has you covered. This user guide is designed to help you get the most out of your Android Auto™ experience, so sit back, relax, and let's get started.

Chapter 1. Introduction

This section provides a brief overview of Android Auto and its purpose. Android Auto is a mobile app that integrates with a car's infotainment system, allowing for convenient access to features such as music, navigation, messaging, and more. The user guide serves as a comprehensive guide to the app, offering information on its setup, features, and customization options to make the most of the driving experience.

Overview of Android Auto

Android Auto is a mobile app developed by Google that integrates with your car's infotainment system, allowing you to access a variety of features and apps directly from your car's display. Android Auto makes it safer and more convenient to use your phone while driving, by allowing you to control music, navigation, messaging, and more using voice commands or the touch screen in your vehicle.

Purpose of this User Guide

This user guide is designed to provide a comprehensive overview of Android Auto and its features, so that you can make the most of the app while on the road. Whether you're new to Android Auto or simply looking to learn more about its capabilities, this guide will walk you through everything you need to know to get started with the app, from setting it up to using its various features and customizing your settings. The goal of this guide is to help you understand how to use Android Auto effectively, so that you can stay connected, entertained, and informed while driving.

Chapter 2. Getting Started

The purpose of Android Auto is to provide a seamless and intuitive experience for users who want to bring the power of their Android phone into their car. This system allows users to easily access their favorite apps, music, navigation, and other features while driving in a safer and more convenient way. Android Auto integrates with the car's in-dash display, making it simple to control functions and access information without having to look away from the road. The goal of Android Auto is to enhance the driving experience, provide peace of mind, and help users stay connected to the world around them.

This section covers the steps for setting up and using Android Auto for the first time.

Compatibility Requirements

Android Auto needs to meet the below mentioned pre-requisites to run seamlessly. Android Auto runs on certain requirements for both Android smartphones and cars.

- Check if your Android phone is running at least Android 5.0 (Lollipop)
- Check if your car has a compatible infotainment system or an aftermarket head unit
- Make sure your phone and car are compatible with Android Auto by checking the list of supported vehicles and phone models on the Android Auto website
- If your car is not compatible, consider purchasing an aftermarket head unit that supports Android Auto
- Make sure your phone is updated with the latest software and security updates
- Ensure your phone has a strong and stable connection to the internet (Wi-Fi or cellular data)
- Make sure your car's infotainment system is up to date with the latest software updates from the manufacturer.



Note: It's important to note that not all vehicles or aftermarket stereos are compatible with Android Auto. It's recommended to check the manufacturer's website or contact them to verify compatibility before making a purchase.

Installation

Installation of the Android Auto App. Follow these given steps to get the app up and running.

1. Open the Google Play Store app on your Android phone
2. Search for "**Android Auto**"
3. Find the Android Auto app in the search results and tap on it
4. Tap "**Install**" to download and install the app on your phone
5. Wait for the app to finish installing

The Android Auto app is successfully installed on your Android phone, enabling its usage in your car. Upon completion of the installation, the app can be launched and its features, including access to music, navigation, messaging, and more, can be utilized while driving.



Note: Android Auto is a mobile app that runs on your Android phone and integrates with your car's infotainment system. You simply connect your phone to your car, either through a USB cable or wirelessly, to use the app. You do not need to install anything in your car to use Android Auto. The app runs on your phone and uses your car's display to show the app's interface.

Connect your device

This section provides a step-by-step guide for connecting your Android phone to your vehicle using Android Auto. By following these steps, you can start using Android Auto in your car.

1. Start your car and make sure it's in park.
2. Connect your Android phone to your car using a USB cable or, if your car supports it, a wireless connection.
3. Follow the on-screen instructions provided by your car's manufacturer to complete the connection process.
4. On your Android phone, tap "**Connect**" or "**Start**" on the Android Auto app.
5. Wait for the connection to be established between your phone and your car.



Important: Some car models may require a software update to enable compatibility with Android Auto. Contact your car manufacturer for more information

Setup

Follow the steps provided below to set up Android Auto:

1. Launch the Android Auto app on your Android phone.
2. Follow the on-screen prompts to grant the app the necessary permissions, such as access to your contacts, location, and storage.
3. Customize your Android Auto settings, such as the color scheme and background image, to your preferences.
4. Connect your phone to your car, as outlined in the topic [Connect your device \(on page 12\)](#)
5. Wait for the connection to be established between your phone and your car.
6. On your car's display, tap the "Android Auto" icon to start using the app. Review and agree to the terms and conditions for using Android Auto.

Opening Android Auto

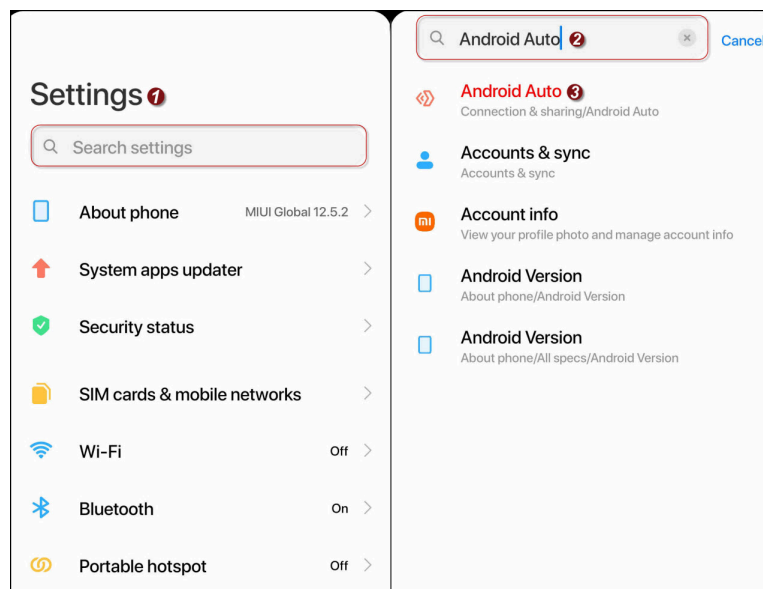
After installing the application from Google Playstore, you can open Android Auto using two ways mentioned below:

1. Search option (or)
2. Manual operation

Opening Android Auto via. search option

1. Navigate to the **Settings** on your phone.
2. Search for "**Android Auto**" in the Search Settings bar
3. Select the Android Auto application from the resulting list to access and open it.

Figure 1. Search Option

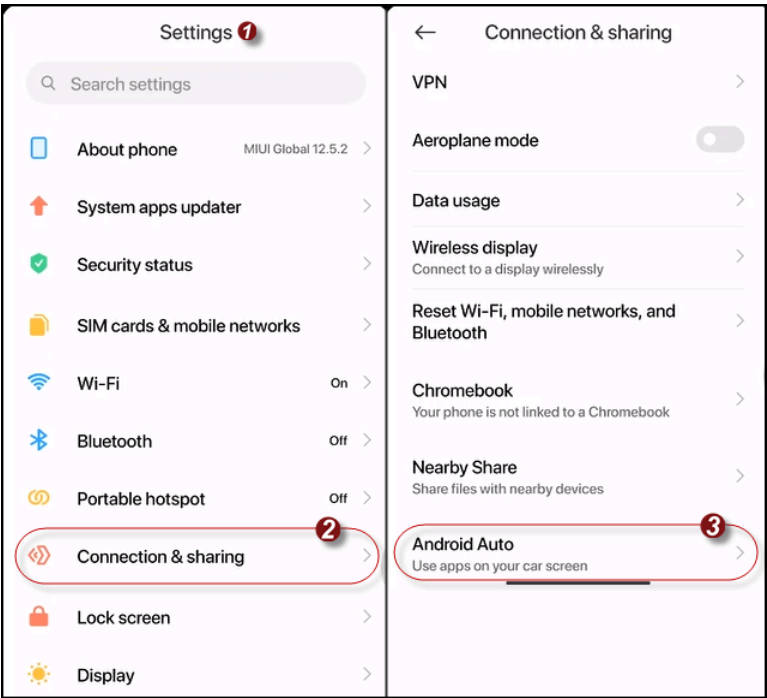


Opening Android Auto via. manual operation

1. Go the phone's **Settings**
2. Click the **Connection & Sharing** option and the screen will navigate to the Connection & Sharing page in the Settings

3. Select the **Android Auto** option.

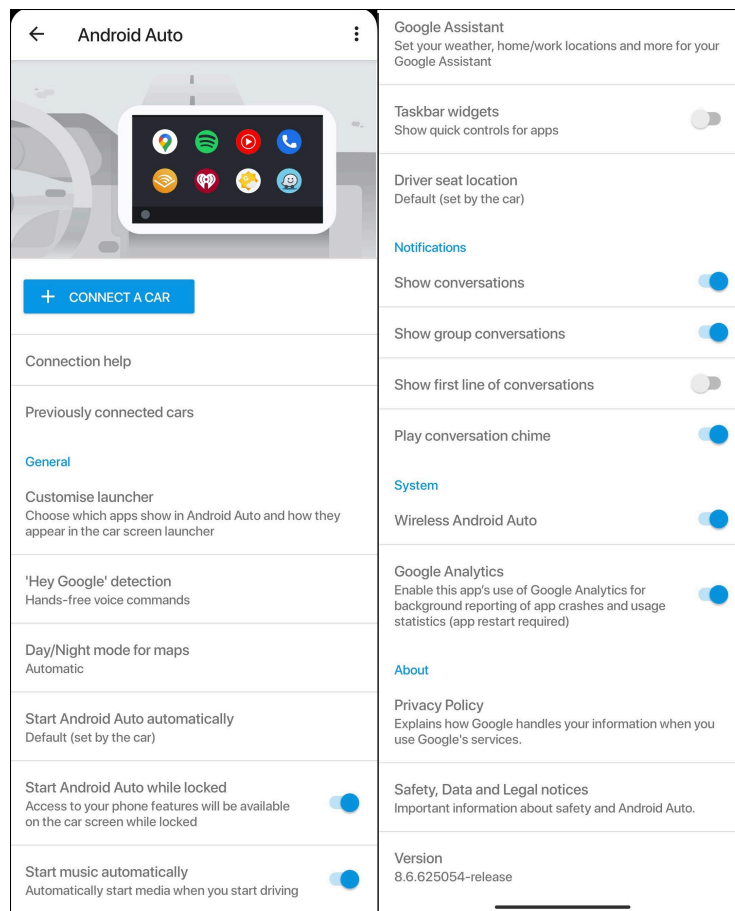
Figure 2. Manual Operation



Chapter 3. Android Auto Home Screen

This section provides an overview and explanation of the main interface of the Android Auto app. This section will describe the various elements and features of the home screen, such as the navigation bar, notifications, quick settings, and app launcher.

Figure 3. Home Screen



The home screen of Android Auto app has four distinctive sections each with its own purpose and functionality:

1. General
2. Notifications
3. System
4. About

You can also see options like **CONNECT A CAR**, **Connection help**, and **Previously connected cars**. Refer the topic *so and so* for more information.

Home Screen Sections

The below table explains the available sections on the Android Auto home screen:

Table 1. Home Screen Sections

S. No	Section	Explanation
1	General	The general section of the home screen provides an overview of the most commonly used apps and functions, such as music, navigation, and phone. You can tap on an app or function to open it and access its features.
2	Notifications	The notifications section displays any new notifications you have received on your phone, such as text messages, emails, or app updates. You can swipe through the notifications to view each one, and tap on a notification to open it and take action.
3	System	The system section provides access to important system controls and settings, such as the settings app, volume controls, and screen brightness. You can tap on an option in the system section to open it and access its features.
4	About	The about section provides information about your Android Auto app, such as the version number and copyright information. This section is useful for troubleshooting and support purposes.

General

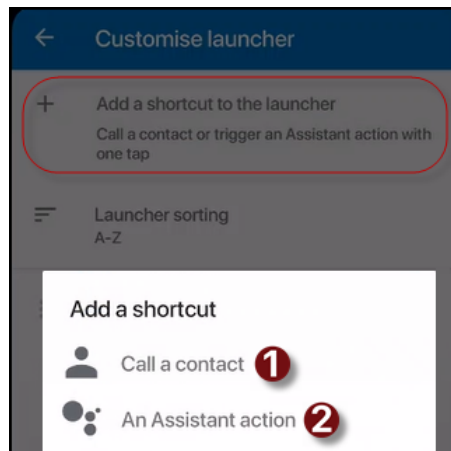
The General section is where you can access and manage various customization options and settings for the Android Auto app. From here, you can choose how the app functions and behaves, so it works best for you

Customise launcher

Click "**Add a shortcut to the launcher**" option to set up either a contact or an Assistant action or both with one tap.

1. To add a quick shortcut contact from the existing contact list, click the **Call a contact** option.
2. Tap the **An Assistant Action**. Enter the **Assistant command** and **Launcher icon label** details in the dedicated fields. Click the **CREATE SHORTCUT** button to trigger the assistant action.

Figure 4. Assistant Action Shortcuts



3. The shortcuts can be added, and removed by checking and unchecked the required items. To sort the items in alphabetical order, click the **Launcher sorting** option.

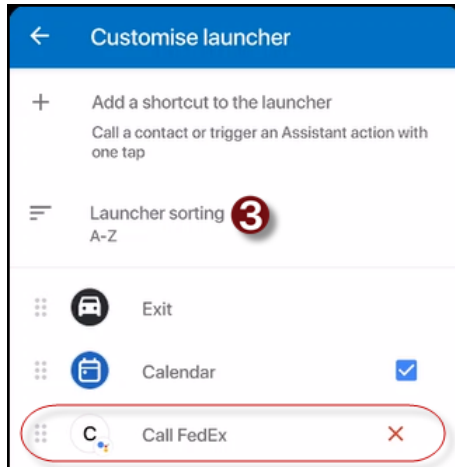


Note: You can always test the command for Assistant action using the "TEST COMMAND" button. Once the required shortcut actions are configured, the created shortcut is displayed in the Launcher as shown in Figure 4.



Sample commands: "Play Dandelions song" or "Read my messages"

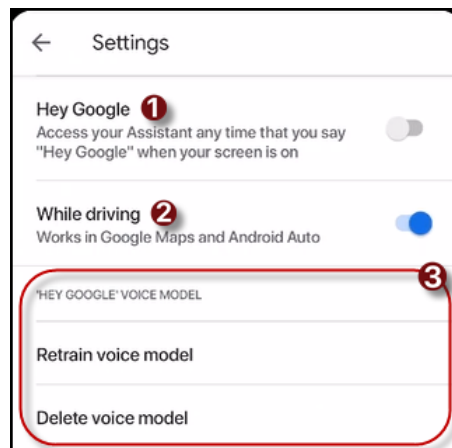
Figure 5. One tap activation



'Hey Google' detection

'Hey Google' detection refers to the ability of the Android Auto app to recognize and respond to the user's voice command, "Hey Google." When this feature is enabled, the user can initiate a Google Assistant request by simply saying "Hey Google" followed by their request.

1. To enable Google voice detection, toggle the **Hey Google** button on. Click **Next** and **I agree** on the following confirmation screens to activate voice match on your device. In the final screen, once Hey Google is ready, feed and train your voice.
2. By default **While driving** toggle button will be on and it is recommended to keep it on for easy Google Maps navigation and Android Auto voice commands.

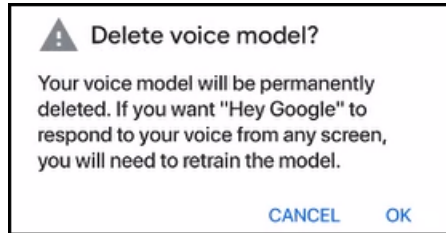
Figure 6. Hey Google detection

3. The **'Hey Google' Voice Model** section has two options:

- a. **Retrain voice model** - This feature allows you to create a new voice model specifically tailored to your speaking style and accent. By doing so, the app can better understand what you're saying, leading to more accurate and effective voice recognition. To retrain your voice model, you will typically be prompted to repeat a set of phrases and commands so that the app can learn your speaking style. This process usually takes a few minutes, and once completed, the app will use your new voice model to respond to your voice commands. By regularly retraining your voice model, you can ensure that the app continues to accurately recognize your voice commands and provide a seamless voice-controlled experience.
- b. **Delete voice model** - This feature allows you to reset the app's understanding of your voice and start fresh with a new voice model. When you delete your voice model, the app will no longer recognize your voice commands, and you will need to retrain your voice model for the app to respond accurately. This feature can be useful if you're experiencing issues with voice recognition or

if you simply want to start fresh with a new voice model. To delete your voice model, click OK in the "Delete voice model" deletion confirmation window.

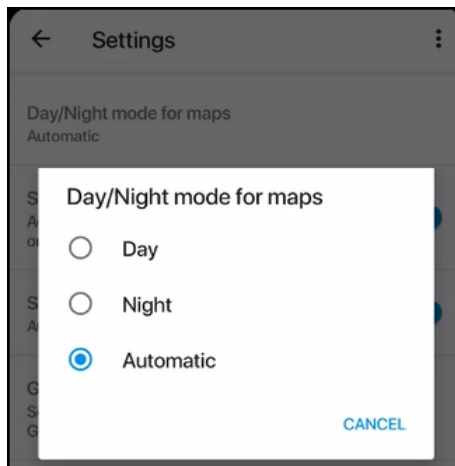
Figure 7. Voice model deletion confirmation



Day/Night mode for maps

Android Auto provides a "Day/Night" mode for maps which changes the display to a lighter or darker theme to make it easier to see the map during the day or night. The **Day** mode uses a lighter color palette with bright colors and high contrast, while the **Night** mode uses a darker color palette with low contrast and muted colors. This mode can be manually switched or set to **automatically** switch based on the current time and location. The main goal of this feature is to provide a safer and more comfortable driving experience by reducing eye strain and making it easier to see the maps on the car's display.

Figure 8. Day/Night mode for maps

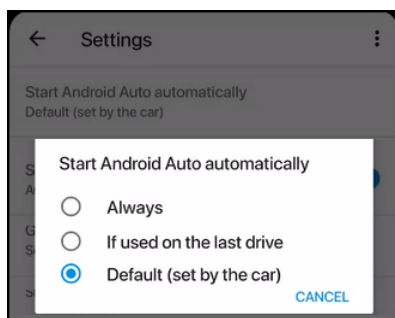


Start Android Auto automatically

Android Auto can be set to start automatically when the car is connected to a compatible device, eliminating the need for manual intervention. The option to start Android Auto automatically is available in the settings, and offers three different choices:

- **Always** - this option will start Android Auto automatically every time the car is connected to a compatible device, regardless of whether it was used on the last device or not.
- **If used on the last device** - this option will start Android Auto automatically if it was used on the last device, but not if it was not used.
- **Default (set by the car)** - this option is determined by the car's settings and can vary depending on the make and model of the vehicle. Some cars may always start Android Auto automatically, while others may require manual intervention to start the app.

Figure 9. Start Android Auto Automatically



The **Start Android Auto automatically** feature provides a convenient way to use Android Auto, as it eliminates the need to manually start the app each time the car is connected to a compatible device. Drivers can choose the option that best suits their needs and preferences.



Note: Toggle the **Start Android Auto while locked** option in Android Auto to launch the app automatically when the car is connected to a compatible device, even if the phone is locked. This means that the automobilist can start using Android Auto without having to unlock their phone and manually launch the app.

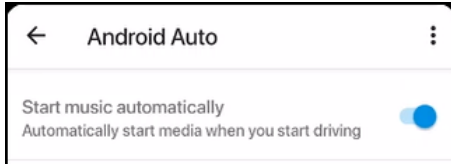
Start music automatically

Android Auto provides an option to start playing music automatically when the app is launched. This feature can be enabled in the settings, and once activated, Android Auto will play music from the user's preferred music source as soon as the app is launched.

The music source can be set to a specific app, such as Spotify or Apple music, or it can be set to play music from the phone's library. Once the music starts playing, users can control

playback from the Android Auto interface, including adjusting the volume, skipping tracks, and pausing the music. This feature is particularly useful for automobilists who want to listen to music as soon as they start their car, without having to manually start the app and select their preferred music source. It helps to create a seamless and enjoyable driving experience, allowing the automobilist to focus on the road while their music plays in the background.

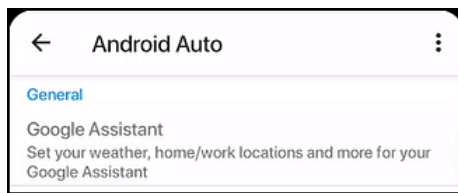
Figure 10. Start Music Automatically



Google Assistant

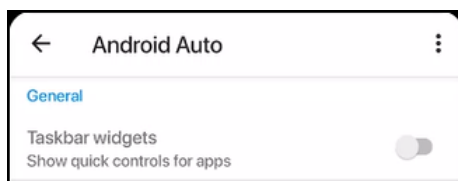
You need to have Google Assistant already configured for Android Auto to make phone calls, send text messages, play music, get directions, and access other apps and services using voice commands. If Google Assistant is not configured, follow the steps given below:

1. Open the Google Assistant app on your Android device
2. Tap on the three dots on the top right corner of the screen and select "**Settings**"
3. In the "Settings" menu, tap on "**Google Assistant**"
4. On the next screen, tap on "**Assistant**" and then "**Assistant voice**"
5. Select the voice and language you prefer.
6. To activate the Google Assistant, press and hold the Home button or say "Ok Google"
7. You can also change the activation phrase to something else in the "Assistant" section of the settings menu
8. To customize the Google Assistant's functionality, go back to the "Settings" menu and select "Assistant devices"
9. From here, you can add or remove devices, and adjust the settings for each device
10. Once you've made your changes, you're ready to start using Google Assistant on your Android device.

Figure 11. Google Assistant

Taskbar widgets

The Taskbar widgets feature in Android Auto allows you to quickly access and control various apps from the taskbar. This toggle feature is located in the Android Auto settings and when enabled, displays widgets for frequently used apps on the taskbar. This allows users to quickly switch between different apps and access important information, such as music playback controls, navigation directions, and more, without having to navigate away from the main interface. This reduces the need to switch between different screens and minimizing distractions while driving. Additionally, the taskbar widgets can be customized as per preferences.

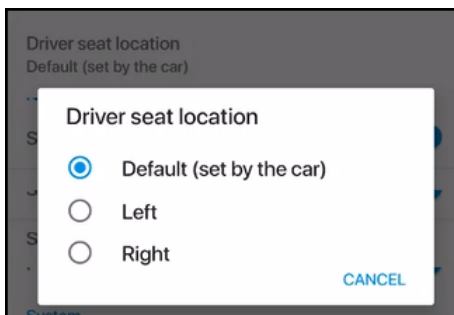
Figure 12. Taskbar widgets

Driver seat location

The Driver seat location option in Android Auto allows you to specify which side of the vehicle the driver is seated on. This is an important setting as it helps ensure that navigation instructions and other critical information is displayed correctly. There are three options available:

- **Default:** This option means that Android Auto will use the system default setting for the driver seat location. The default setting is usually based on the device's location and other information, such as the country or region where the device is being used.
- **Left:** This option specifies that the driver is seated on the left side of the vehicle. This setting is useful for drivers in countries where the driver is seated on the left side of the vehicle, such as the UK and Australia.
- **Right:** This option specifies that the driver is seated on the right side of the vehicle. This setting is useful for drivers in countries where the driver is seated on the right side of the vehicle, such as the US and Canada.

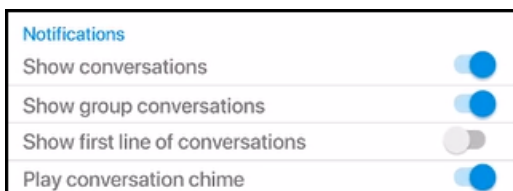
Figure 13. Driver Seat Location



Notifications

The Notifications section in Android Auto refers to the settings related to the display and notification sound for incoming messages. The following are the options available:

Figure 14. Notifications



Show conversations

The Show conversations option in the Notification section of Android Auto determines how incoming message notifications are displayed on the screen of your Android Auto-enabled

vehicle. When this option is selected, the entire conversation thread for incoming messages will be displayed on the screen. This means that you can view the full text of incoming messages, including previous messages exchanged in the same conversation. This feature is designed to provide a more complete and contextual view of incoming messages, so you can quickly see what someone is trying to communicate to you. By having the ability to view the entire conversation thread, you can avoid the need to navigate back and forth between different messages, or having to memorize the context of a previous message. It also helps to reduce distractions and make it easier to respond to incoming messages without having to switch between different apps.

Show group conversations

Show group conversations refers to the display of group conversation threads for incoming messages on the Android Auto interface. When this option is selected, group conversations received on your phone will be displayed in the Android Auto interface, allowing you to easily see and respond to group messages while driving. This option is useful for people who frequently participate in group conversations and want to stay connected while on the road. The group conversation thread will be displayed in a similar manner to individual conversations, with each message in the thread shown in sequence. You can respond to a group message using the Android Auto interface by typing a reply or selecting a pre-written message from the list of quick replies. This option provides a convenient way to stay connected to group chats while driving, helping to keep you informed and up-to-date without requiring you to take your eyes off the road.

Show first line of conversations

The Show first line of conversations option in Android Auto determines how incoming messages will be displayed on the screen. When this option is selected, only the first line of the incoming message will be displayed. This means that the recipient or sender's name and the beginning of the message content will be shown, but the rest of the message will be hidden. This option can be useful for those who prefer to see only a quick preview of incoming messages without having to navigate to the full message. It can also help to save screen time and reduce distractions while driving.

Play conversation chime

Play conversation chime is an option allows you to enable or disable a sound notification for incoming messages. When the option is enabled, a sound will be played when a new message is received. The purpose of the chime is to alert you that a new message has arrived, even if you're not currently looking at the screen. The sound that is played is referred to as a "conversation chime." This sound is distinct from other sounds used for notifications and alerts, such as ringtones or notifications for incoming calls. The chime is specifically designed to alert you to incoming messages, so you can quickly and easily respond to them if necessary.

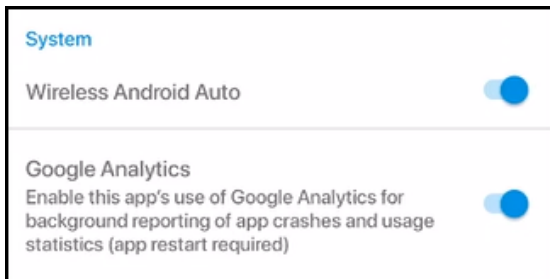


Note: You can customize the sound of the chime if desired, or turn it off altogether if you prefer to rely on visual notifications instead.

System

The System section in Android Auto refers to the settings related to the overall system and performance of the platform. The following are the options available under the "System" section:

Figure 15. System



Wireless Android Auto

This option allows you to connect your Android device to a compatible car display using Wi-Fi, without the need for a physical connection (such as a USB cable). Wireless Android Auto is a convenient way to use the platform without having to worry about cables and wires getting in the way.

Google Analytics

This option allows you to enable or disable the collection of usage data for Android Auto. When enabled, anonymous usage data is sent to Google to help improve the platform and provide you with a better experience. The data collected may include information about the frequency and duration of use, the types of apps used, and other similar data.

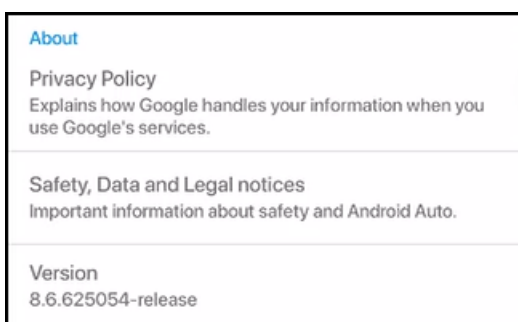


Note: Disabling "Google Analytics" in Android Auto stops the collection of anonymous usage data, including app usage, frequency, and duration. It won't affect functionality but may limit platform improvements. Data helps Google enhance user experience, but if privacy concerns arise, disabling the option will opt out of data collection.

About

The About section in Android Auto typically provides information about the software and its associated features. As a user of the app, you need have certain awareness of the application's privacy policy, safety and general details; this section sheds light on these topics:

Figure 16. About



Privacy Policy

Privacy Policy option provides information about the company's privacy policies and how it handles personal information collected from users. It explains what data is collected, how it is used, and who it is shared with. This information is important for users to understand their

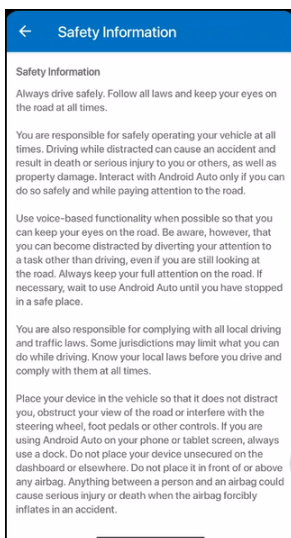
rights and how their personal information is being used. Once you click the option, you will be directed to the web page <https://policies.google.com/privacy?hl=en>

Safety, Data and Legal notices

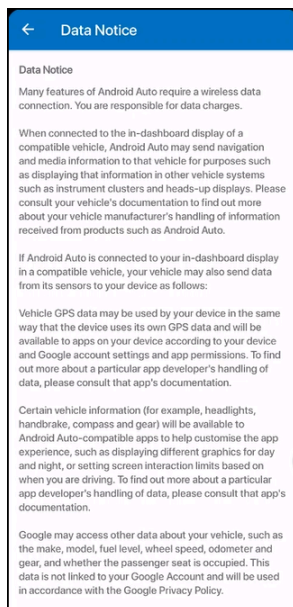
This topic provides important safety and legal information related to the use of Android Auto. It may include information about safety regulations, product liability, and other legal notices that users should be aware of. This information is important for users to understand the risks associated with using the software and how to stay safe while using it.

Safety Information: This section provides information about the safety aspects of using the software. This includes information about any potential hazards or risks associated with using the software, as well as any precautions that users should take to ensure their safety while using it. Safety information is important to understand so that users can use the software safely and responsibly.

Figure 17. Safety Information

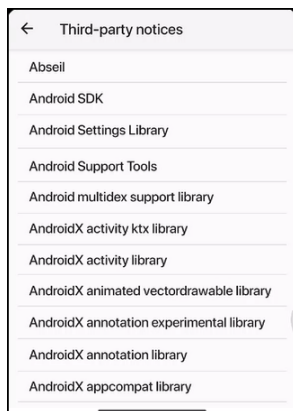


Data Notice: This section provides information about the data collected by Android Auto and how it is used. It explains what data is collected, how it is processed, and who it is shared with. This information is important for users to understand their rights and to make informed decisions about the use of their personal data.

Figure 18. Data Notice

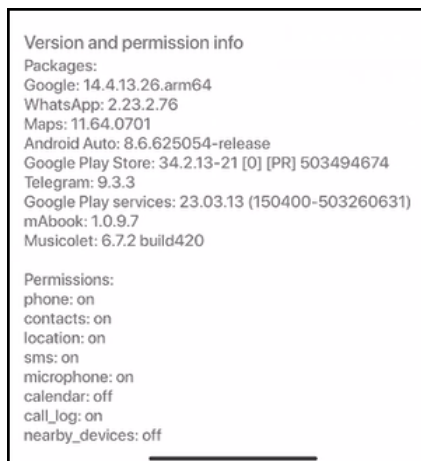
Terms of service: This section provides information about the terms and conditions of using Android Auto. It explains the rules and guidelines that users must follow when using the software, and any limitations or restrictions that may apply. It is important for users to understand these terms and conditions to ensure that they are using the software in a legal and acceptable manner. Once you click this option, you will be navigated to the web page <https://policies.google.com/terms?hl=en>

Open-Source Licences: This section provides information about any open-source software components that are used in Android Auto. It explains the licensing terms associated with these components, including any restrictions on their use, distribution, or modification. It is important for users to understand these licensing terms to ensure that they are using the software in a legal and acceptable manner.

Figure 19. Third-party notices

Version

This topic provides information about the current version of Android Auto that is installed on the user's device. This information may include the version number, release date, and a list of updates and changes included in the current version. This information is important for users to know if they have the latest version of the software and if there are any updates available.

Figure 20. Version

Chapter 4. Navigation

Navigation in Android Auto refers to the ability to get directions and navigate to a desired destination using the app. The Navigation section of the app provides multiple ways to get directions and navigate to your desired destination, including using Google Maps, other navigation apps, and voice commands.

Getting Directions

Getting directions in Android Auto is simple and straightforward, making it easy to get to your desired destination quickly and efficiently.

1. Open the Android Auto app on your phone
2. Tap the Navigation icon (a compass) on the home screen
3. Enter your desired destination into the search bar
4. Select the desired destination from the list of suggested destinations
5. Tap on Start Navigation to begin receiving turn-by-turn directions to your destination
6. You can also choose to use a different navigation app by tapping on the app name in the bottom left corner of the screen.

Using Google Maps

Google Maps is a widely used and highly regarded navigation app that provides detailed turn-by-turn directions, real-time traffic updates, and more.

1. Open the Android Auto app on your phone
2. Tap the Navigation icon (a compass) on the home screen
3. Enter your desired destination into the search bar
4. Select the desired destination from the list of suggested destinations
5. Tap on Start Navigation to begin receiving turn-by-turn directions to your destination using Google Maps
6. You can also choose to use a different navigation app by tapping on the app name in the bottom left corner of the screen.

Using Other Navigation Apps

In addition to Google Maps, Android Auto also allows you to use other navigation apps, providing you with multiple options for getting directions and navigating to your desired destination.

1. Open the Android Auto app on your phone
2. Tap the Navigation icon (a compass) on the home screen
3. Enter your desired destination into the search bar
4. Select the desired destination from the list of suggested destinations
5. Tap on the app name in the bottom left corner of the screen
6. Select the desired navigation app from the list of available apps Tap on Start Navigation to begin receiving turn-by-turn directions to your destination using the selected navigation app.

Navigating with Voice Commands

Using voice commands to navigate with Android Auto is a convenient and hands-free way to get directions and reach your desired destination.

1. Open the Android Auto app on your phone
2. Tap the Navigation icon (a compass) on the home screen
3. Say "Hey Google, navigate to [desired destination]" to initiate navigation using voice commands
4. The app will begin providing turn-by-turn directions to your desired destination using Google Maps or another navigation app, as specified in your settings.

Chapter 5. Music and Audio

With Android Auto you can listen to music, play music from different services, play podcasts and audiobooks, and control audio with voice commands.

Listening to Music

To listen to music in Android Auto, simply connect your smartphone to the vehicle's infotainment system. Android Auto will automatically launch, giving you access to your music library, playlists, and other music content. You can select a song, album, or playlist to play and control playback using the vehicle's infotainment system or the Android Auto app on your smartphone.

Playing Music from Different Services

Android Auto supports multiple music streaming services, such as Spotify, Google Play Music, and others. To play music from a different service, simply select the service from the Android Auto menu and log in with your account. You can then browse and play music from the selected service, just as you would on your smartphone.

Playing Podcasts and Audiobooks

To play podcasts and audiobooks in Android Auto, select the appropriate app from the Android Auto menu, such as Google Podcasts or Audible. You can then browse and play content from the selected app, just as you would on your smartphone.

Controlling Audio with Voice Commands

Android Auto supports voice commands, allowing you to control audio playback hands-free. You can use voice commands to play, pause, skip, and control the volume of your audio content. Simply press the voice command button on your vehicle's infotainment system or the Android Auto app on your smartphone, and use voice commands to control audio playback.

Chapter 6. Phone Calls

Phone Calls on Android Auto allow drivers to make, receive, control, and handle calls while driving in a safe and convenient manner.

Making Calls

Follow the steps given below to make calls using Android Auto:

1. Open the Android Auto app on your phone
2. Connect your phone to your vehicle's infotainment system or to a compatible aftermarket display
3. Tap the Phone icon on the Android Auto home screen
4. Enter the name or number of the person you want to call into the search bar
5. Tap the name or number of the person you want to call
6. Tap the green call button to initiate the call.

Receiving Calls

When you receive a call, a call notification will appear on the Android Auto home screen

- To answer the call, simply tap the **green** answer button
- To reject the call, tap the **red** reject button

Controlling Calls with Voice Commands

To have control over phone calls on Android Auto in your vehicle using voice commands, follow these simple steps:

1. To control calls using voice commands, you must first activate the voice command system by pressing the voice command button on your steering wheel or infotainment system
2. To make a call using voice commands, say "**Call [name or number]**" i.e. "Call John Doe"
3. To answer a call using voice commands, say "**Answer**"
4. To reject a call using voice commands, say "**Decline**"

5. During a call, you can also use voice commands to perform actions such as hanging up, putting the call on hold, or switching between callers.



Remember: You need to configure the voice commands like "Hang up the call", "Switch to Sam's call" or "Put the caller on hold". Unless and until the required commands are configured, you cannot get the full hands-free experience.

Handling Missed Calls

When you miss a call, a missed call notification will appear on the Android Auto home screen

- To call back the missed caller, tap the missed call notification
- To clear the missed call notification, swipe it away.

Chapter 7. Messaging

Messaging on Android Auto is a feature that allows you to send, receive, and manage messages while you're driving.

Sending Messages

To send a message on Android Auto, you need to have an active messaging app installed on your phone.

1. You can initiate a message by tapping the "**Messages**" icon on the Android Auto home screen
2. Then, select the recipient from your contacts or enter their phone number
3. Finally, type your message and tap "**Send**."

Receiving Messages

When you receive a message, you'll see a notification on the Android Auto home screen.

1. Tap the notification to open the messaging app and read the message
2. If the messaging app is compatible with the connected vehicle, you may hear an audio notification when you receive a message

Replying to Messages with Voice Commands

To reply to messages using voice commands, say "**Ok Google**" followed by "**Reply to [message]**" and then dictate your reply. Android Auto will transcribe your voice message and send it to the recipient.

Managing Notifications

Notifications can be managed by tapping the "**Notifications**" button on the Android Auto home screen. From there, you can view, reply to, or dismiss the message.

Chapter 8. Google Assistant

Google Assistant is a virtual assistant developed by Google that uses voice commands to perform tasks, answer questions, and provide information. The Google Assistant is integrated into Android Auto and provides a convenient way for drivers to interact with their phone while driving.

Overview of Google Assistant

Google Assistant is a virtual assistant that uses natural language processing and machine learning to understand and respond to voice commands. It can perform a variety of tasks, such as setting reminders, playing music, and providing information, among others

Using Google Assistant with Android Auto

To use Google Assistant with Android Auto, drivers need to connect their phone to their car's infotainment system using a USB cable. Once connected, drivers can access Google Assistant by pressing the microphone button on the Android Auto home screen.

Controlling Your Phone with Voice Commands

Google Assistant on Android Auto allows drivers to control their phone with voice commands. This means that drivers can make calls, send messages, and perform other tasks without having to take their hands off the wheel. Some common voice commands include "Call John Doe," "Send a text to Jane Doe," and "Play my favorite playlist."

Getting Help and Information

Google Assistant on Android Auto can also provide drivers with help and information. Drivers can ask for directions, get the latest news, or ask for information about a specific topic. Google Assistant will use the internet to find the information and provide it to the driver.

Chapter 9. Third-party Apps

Third-Party Apps on Android Auto refers to apps that are developed by companies or individuals other than Google. These apps can be used to enhance the Android Auto experience and add new functionality to the platform.

Overview of Third-Party Apps

Third-party apps are apps that are created by developers other than the manufacturer of Google. On Android Auto, these are apps that are not built into the platform by Google, but instead are downloaded from the Google Play Store by the user. In comparison, Google's built-in apps on Android Auto are apps that come pre-installed on the platform and are designed and developed by Google specifically for Android Auto. These built-in apps typically include Google Maps for navigation, Google Play Music for music streaming, and Google Assistant for voice control. Third-party apps offer additional functionality and features not provided by the built-in apps and can be used to enhance the user experience on Android Auto.

There are several categories of third-party apps that are available for Android Auto, each with its own unique set of features and functions. Some of the most common categories include:

- **Navigation:** Third-party navigation apps for Android Auto include popular options like Waze, Google Maps, and others. These apps provide turn-by-turn directions, real-time traffic information, and other features that help drivers reach their destination more efficiently.
- **Entertainment:** Entertainment apps for Android Auto provide users with access to music, videos, podcasts, and other forms of audio and video content while they are driving. Some popular examples include Spotify, YouTube Music, and Google Podcasts.
- **Productivity:** Productivity apps for Android Auto help drivers stay organized and on top of their tasks while they are on the road. Examples include calendars, to-do lists, and note-taking apps.

- **Messaging:** Messaging apps for Android Auto allow drivers to send and receive text messages, voice messages, and other forms of communication while they are driving. Examples include WhatsApp, Facebook Messenger, and Google Messages.
- **News and Information:** News and information apps for Android Auto provide drivers with up-to-date news, weather, and other important information that can help them stay informed and make better driving decisions. Examples include Google News, NPR One, and Pocket Casts.

There are several benefits of using Third-Party Apps on Android Auto:

- **Increased functionality:** Third-party apps can offer features and functionality that are not available in Google's built-in apps. For example, a third-party navigation app may offer real-time traffic updates or alternative routes that are not available in the built-in maps app.
- **Customization options:** Third-party apps can offer greater customization options compared to built-in apps, allowing users to tailor the app to their specific needs and preferences.
- **Improved user experience:** Third-party apps can provide a more user-friendly and intuitive interface, making it easier for users to access and use the app while driving.
- **More options:** Third-party apps can offer a wider range of choices compared to built-in apps, allowing users to select the app that best suits their needs and preferences.
- **Regular updates:** Third-party apps are typically updated more frequently compared to built-in apps, ensuring that users have access to the latest features and bug fixes.

Using Popular Apps with Android Auto

Here is a list of popular third-party apps that are compatible with Android Auto:

Table 2. Popular compatible third-party apps

Label	Apps
Navigation	Waze, Google Maps, Sygic, HERE WeGo
Music and Audio	Spotify, Pandora, iHeartRadio, Amazon Music
Communication	WhatsApp, Skype, Telegram, Slack

Table 2. Popular compatible third-party apps (continued)

Label	Apps
News and Podcasts	Stitcher, Podcast Addict, Audible, Google Podcasts
Sports	ESPN, CBS Sports, NFL, NBA
Social Media	Twitter, Facebook, Instagram
Productivity	Todoist, Evernote, Google Keep, IFTTT
Travel:	Expedia, Kayak, Airbnb, Booking.com
Games	Asphalt 9, Solitaire, Chess, Sudoku
Others	AutoMate, Podcast Player, AutoSleep, CastBox

These apps can be installed from Google Play store. Refer topic [Installation \(on page 12\)](#)

To set up and connect these apps to run seamlessly on Android Auto, refer [Connect your device \(on page 12\)](#) and [Setup \(on page 13\)](#)

Customizing Android Auto Experience with Third-Party Apps

1. You can use Third-Party Apps to customize the look and feel of Android Auto, by selecting different themes and skins. Some popular apps for customizing the appearance of Android Auto include:
 - **AutoMate:** This app allows you to change the background and color scheme of Android Auto.
 - **Navbar Apps:** This app allows you to customize the navigation bar with different colors, icons, and styles.
 - **iKozmik Wallpapers:** This app provides a wide range of high-quality wallpapers for Android Auto.
2. You can manage and organize Third-Party Apps on Android Auto. To achieve this follow the steps provided below:
 - a. On your Android device, go to "**Settings**" and then "**Google**" and then "**Android Auto**"
 - b. Select "**Apps**"

- c. Tap on the app you want to manage or organize
- d. From here, you can control the visibility of the app on Android Auto, by enabling or disabling the "**Show on Android Auto**" option and the app's notification settings, by enabling or disabling the "**Show notifications**" option



Sample: Let's say you have the Third-Party App "**Waze**" installed on your Android device and you want to manage its visibility and notifications on Android Auto, go to Device Settings → Google → Android Auto → Apps → Waze. To control the visibility of Waze on Android Auto, toggle the "**Show on Android Auto**" option on or off. If you turn it off, Waze will not appear in the list of available apps when you use Android Auto. Follow the same step using the "**Show notifications**" toggle button to control Waze's notification settings.

Chapter 10. Tips and Tricks

Whether you're commuting to work, running errands, or going on a road trip, Android Auto helps you stay connected while keeping your eyes on the road and your hands on the wheel. However, there are several tips and tricks that can make using Android Auto even more enjoyable and efficient. In this section, we'll cover some of the most important tips and tricks for using Android Auto, including voice commands, customization options, notifications, and safety features. By following these tips, you'll be able to get the most out of your Android Auto experience and stay safe on the road.

Voice Commands

Android Auto allows you to control your device hands-free using voice commands. You can use voice commands to make calls, send messages, get directions, play music, and more. To use voice commands, simply say "Hey Google" or press the microphone button on your Android Auto display and give your command.

Customization

Android Auto provides various customization options to make the user experience more personalized. You can customize the layout of the home screen, change the background, set a custom message for incoming calls, and more. Additionally, third-party apps can be used to further customize the Android Auto experience.

Notifications

Android Auto allows you to manage your notifications to minimize distractions while driving. You can customize which notifications appear on your Android Auto display, and also choose to have notifications read aloud to you. Android Auto also provides options for managing and silencing notifications while driving.

Safety

Android Auto is designed with safety in mind, providing features that help minimize distractions while driving. For example, Android Auto's user interface is designed to be easy to navigate, with larger buttons and simplified menus to reduce the need for complex

interactions. Additionally, Android Auto provides hands-free voice commands to control your device, allowing you to keep your hands on the wheel and eyes on the road.

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